



OWNER'S GUIDE • NO. 02

Playing GLIDE

Four rows of keys, played like four strings. The scale is handled for you, so the first thing you press already sounds right — everything after that is the sliding.

You can't really hit a wrong note.

Every key is a note of the current scale — A minor pentatonic out of the box — so there are no dead keys and nothing to avoid. Press anything. The skill isn't finding the right note; it's how you move between them.

THE FOUR ROWS ARE FOUR STRINGS

STRING 3 • HIGH	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
STRING 2	q	w	e	r	t	y	u	i	o	p
STRING 1	a	s	d	f	g	h	j	k	l	;
STRING 0 • LOW	z	x	c	v	b	n	m	,	.	/

← the backing row

Left to right walks up the scale. Each row is a register of its own, and behaves like a string: one voice at a time, gliding between whatever you press on it.

EVERYTHING ELSE, AT A GLANCE

shift (hold)	the notes between — off-scale semitones, only while held	fn + q..p	switch between the ten sounds, live
- / =	octave down / up	alt	the loop pedal (left thumb)
[/]	bend down / up	enter	tilt on / off
space	sustain	tab	settings — and a full help screen
bksp	panic — silences everything	ctrl / opt	volume down / up

THE WHOLE MANUAL IS ON THE DEVICE

Press **tab** for settings, then open **help**. Every gesture in this guide is listed there, so you're never stuck without the paper.

ONE

The sliding is the instrument

Four gestures. The first two take a minute; the third is the one people keep the device for.

HOLD ONE KEY • PRESS ANOTHER ON THE SAME ROW

Hammer-on

The voice *glides* to the new note instead of restarting. No new attack, no click — one continuous line, exactly like sliding a finger up a string.

THEN LET THE SECOND ONE GO

Pull-off

It glides back down to the key you're still holding. Hammer and pull together give you trills, grace notes, and the lazy scoops that make a line sound played rather than typed.

HOLD A SHAPE ACROSS ROWS • RE-FINGER IT SOMEWHERE ELSE

Slide a chord — this is the thing

Hold two or three keys across different rows, then move that shape while the old notes still ring. Every voice glides to its new home at once. It's the gesture no keyboard can make and the reason the instrument exists.

HOLD SHIFT

The notes in between

Pure chromatic semitones for as long as you hold it. The scale keeps you safe; **shift** is how you earn the notes it was protecting you from. It's momentary on purpose — let go and you're back on safe ground.

WHAT THE SCREEN IS TELLING YOU

The big waveform is the **real output**, drawn with a phosphor afterglow. The readout above it tracks the lead voice in cents *through* a glide, so you can watch a slide land.

Settings → *Display* swaps it for the **pitch trail**: pitch drawn over time across about seven seconds, with gridlines on the root. Every glide and bend becomes a visible curve.

top left	the sound's name
top middle	key and scale
OCT <i>n</i>	which octave you're in
vox	voices sounding, against the cap
a *	the sound has unsaved edits

TILT

enter turns it on. Lean the device forward and back to morph toward the sound you were last on; tilt it side to side for vibrato. It is never pitch bend — that's what **[** and **]** are for. Settings → *Tilt center* teaches it where *your* flat is.

TWO

The sounds are yours

Ten sounds sit on **fn** + **q** .. **p**, switchable while you play. Eight are a curated bank. The last two are not like anyone else's.

O AND P ARE ROLLED FOR YOUR DEVICE ALONE

Those two slots are generated from a seed created on your Cardputer's very first boot, so no other unit on Earth has them. They aren't stored — they're re-derived from that seed every time, which is why a factory reset brings them back exactly as you know them.

ROLLING YOUR OWN

Press **tab** for settings — **Randomize** and **Mutate** are the two big buttons at the top. Every action auditions itself on the spot with a short lick, so you can judge two rolls by ear.

Randomize	A whole new sound, and a whole new <i>kind</i> of sound. Each roll commits to a character first — a pluck that stops, a bell that rings, a pad that swells, an acid squelch, a wobble bass, a bowed string section, or pure chaos — then paints inside that character's bounds. Guardrails mean a roll is never dead, blown out, or off-key. Roll until you love one.
Mutate	Don't start over — evolve what you have. Gentle keeps the character and nudges it; wild rewrites it. Sculpting toward a vibe instead of pulling a slot machine.
Undo / Redo	Every roll and mutate checkpoints first. You can always step back to the sound you just had, so nothing you liked is ever one tap from gone.
Init	A blank, neutral sound to build up by hand.

KEEPING WHAT YOU FIND

Fast — onto a slot. **fn** + **shift** + **q** .. **p** saves the live sound over that slot. Your ten favourites, always a chord away.

A * in the switch list marks a slot holding a sound of your own.

Unlimited — onto the card. Settings → **Save to SD** writes a **.gpat** file, offering the sound's own auto-name (*warm-haze-3f*) — press **enter** to keep it or type your own. **Load from SD** browses the whole library back.

No card? The instrument plays perfectly without one.

NOTHING YOU SAVE IS AT RISK FROM AN UPDATE

Slots, settings and card files all live outside the program, in a format built to be added to rather than replaced. Installing a new GLIDE cannot touch them — see Owner's Guide No. 01.

THREE

One hand backs, the other solos

Three ways to put something underneath you. All are performance state: they live until you clear them or power off, and none touch your saved sounds.

TAP A KEY ON THE BOTTOM ROW

Drones — the zero-timing option

The bottom row latches. Tap a key and it rings an octave down, hands-free, until you tap it again. Lay down a root, or a root and a fifth, and solo on the rows above. Drones never compete with your lead for voices, and your bends and vibrato move only the solo.

SETTINGS → JAM MOTION: PROGRESSION • THEN TAP CHORDS IN ORDER

A chord progression, spelled with no timing at all

Tap the chords you want in order on the bottom row — four taps for I-IV-V-IV. No metronome, no pocket to hit. The clock walks them one chord per bar, looping, gliding between them, while you solo on top. Each step is a real triad from the current scale, so the backing is in key too.

FN + A • UP, DOWN, UP/DOWN, OFF (+ SHIFT STEPS BACK) • FN + Z RATE • FN + X SPAN

The arpeggiator — the same chords, one note at a time

fn + **a** and whatever the bottom row holds is broken into notes instead of sustained: one tap and that chord runs root-3rd-5th-octave in time, hands-free; four taps and the run walks your progression. It is a texture on the backing, not a new mode — no key changes meaning, and it is off again on every restart, so you can never be stuck in it.

ALT • TAP TO RECORD, TAP TO CLOSE, TAP TO OVERDUB

The loop pedal

It records the *performance*, not the audio — so the loop plays through whichever sound is selected. Record a bassline, switch to a lead, and the whole arrangement re-voices itself. Hold **alt** to clear; **fn** + **alt** peels the last overdub back off.

CHANGE YOUR SOUND OVER A RUNNING JAM AND THE SPLIT APPEARS

Switch patches while a backing is going and it *keeps* the sound it was playing, while the new one becomes your solo voice. Same for octave: shift up and only the solo moves. Lay down a pad, flip to a lead, wail over it. An amber **LK** marks the split; **bksp** clears everything and drops it.

IF A SONG IS PLAYING IN THE ROOM

Hold **fn** + **k** and GLIDE goes quiet and **listens**. The mic works out the song's key and mode from a few seconds of it, and the instrument retunes so your scale fits what's playing. If it lands close but not quite, tap **space** on the result card to cycle the other likely readings, applied live. A quiet room changes nothing and says so. Tapping **fn** + **k** on its own just walks the key up a semitone by hand.

Go and play it. That's the whole point.

The full manual, every setting, and the sounds other people have

